Mahdi Atallah

Beirut, Lebanon

Senior Barista | Coffee Specialist

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SUMMARY

Senior Barista and Coffee Specialist with experience in specialty coffee preparation, café operations, customer service, and team supervision. Skilled in espresso calibration, brewing methods, latte art, inventory control, and maintaining consistent beverage quality in fast-paced environments.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Specialty Coffee Preparation, Espresso Extraction & Calibration, Milk Texturing & Latte Art, Manual Brewing Methods, Coffee Flavor Profiling, Café Operations, Inventory Management, Team Training, Customer Service, Quality & Hygiene Standards, POS Systems & Cash Handling.

EDUCATION

Lebanese International University (LU), *Beirut, Lebanon*

- Bachelor's Degree in Business Management- 2017

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Barista | *Kalei Coffee Co.* 2021 – Present

- Prepare specialty coffee beverages with consistency, precision, and attention to quality.
- Calibrate espresso, texture milk, and create latte art; guide customers on beans, flavor notes, and brewing options.
- Monitor stock levels, maintain equipment cleanliness, and support new-barista training and workflow efficiency.

Barista / Shop Supervisor | *Dunkin' Donuts* 2019 – 2021

- Prepared hot and cold beverages accurately while maintaining freshness and brand standards.
- Supervised bar operations during peak hours and managed daily inventory.
- Provided customer service, resolved complaints, and maintained hygiene standards.

Assistant Manager | Silver *Wings* 2018 – 2019

- Supported daily café operations, staff coordination, and service quality.
- Maintained customer relationships and stock levels while helping improve team workflow and training.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

Barista One – Barista Hustle (BH Learn) | June 2022
Earned this certification after completing the program's core barista training: espresso fundamentals, milk texturing, grinder setup, and everyday workflow behind the bar.

Chemistry of Roasting – The Coffee Sensorium | March 2022
Learned what actually happens inside the bean during roasting, including the chemical reactions that build sweetness, acidity, and aroma.

Multi-Sensory Perception – The Coffee Sensorium | March 2022
Explored how taste, smell, texture, and even sight work together to shape how we experience a cup of coffee.

Coffee Extraction Kinetics – The Coffee Sensorium | March 2022
Studied how grind size, time, temperature, and water flow affect extraction, and how to use that to dial in a better brew.

Aromas in Coffee: Perception and Description – The Coffee Sensorium | March 2022
Trained my nose to recognize common coffee aromas and learned to describe them clearly and consistently.

Aspects of Coffee Freshness – The Coffee Sensorium | April 2022
Covered how coffee changes after roasting, from degassing to staling, and how storage and packaging help keep it fresh.

Coffee Taster's Flavour Wheel: Design and Use – The Coffee Sensorium | April 2022
Learned how the flavour wheel was built and how to use it in practice to pin down and communicate what I taste.

Acidity and Bitterness – The Coffee Sensorium | April 2022
Focused on telling pleasant acidity apart from harsh bitterness, and on the brewing and roasting factors behind each.

Mouthfeel in Beverages – The Coffee Sensorium | April 2022
Looked at body, texture, and weight in the cup, and how they can be adjusted to improve a drink's overall feel.

Introduction to Roasting with Matthew Orchard – Coffee Knowledge Hub | April 2022
Got a practical introduction to roasting, including roast profiles and how different decisions show up in the final cup.

Espresso Masterclass for Barista Competition – Coffee Knowledge Hub | April 2022
Picked up competition-level espresso techniques, with a focus on precision, consistency, and presenting a shot with confidence.

Traceability in Coffee: Building Relationships through Data – Coffee Knowledge Hub | April 2022
Learned how tracking coffee from farm to cup builds transparency and trust between producers, roasters, and customers.

SKILLS

Coffee & Brewing: Espresso calibration and extraction; V60; Chemex; AeroPress; French Press; milk texturing; latte art; coffee origins and flavor profiling.

Operations & Service: Inventory management; equipment cleaning and maintenance; customer service; POS systems; cash handling; working under pressure.

LANGUAGES

Arabic (Native) | English (Fluent)

INTERESTS

Coffee culture | Brewing science | Reading | Hiking